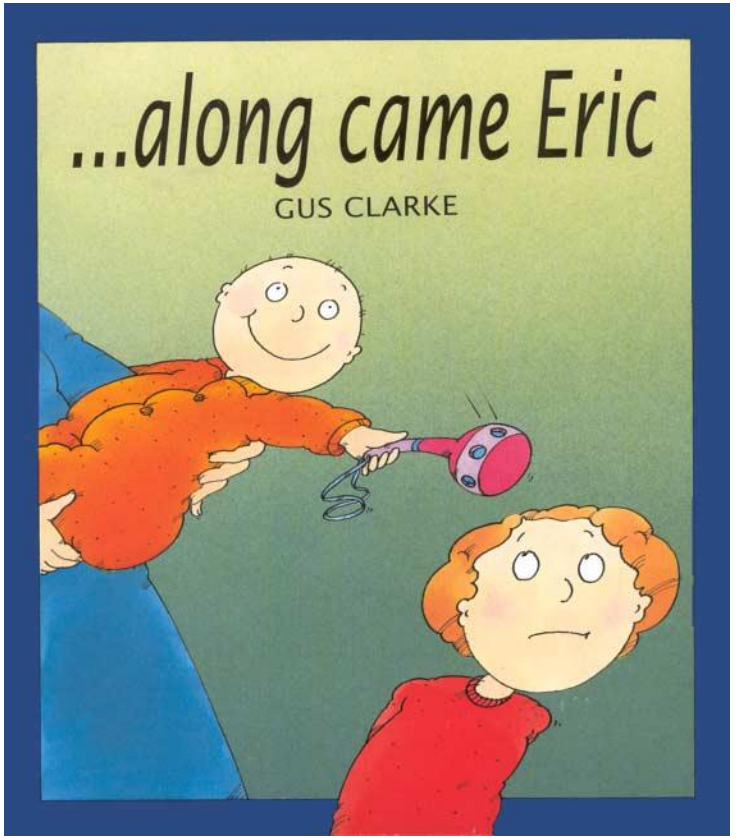
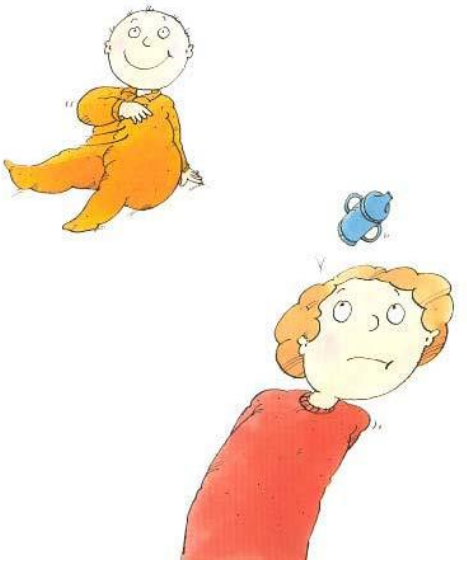


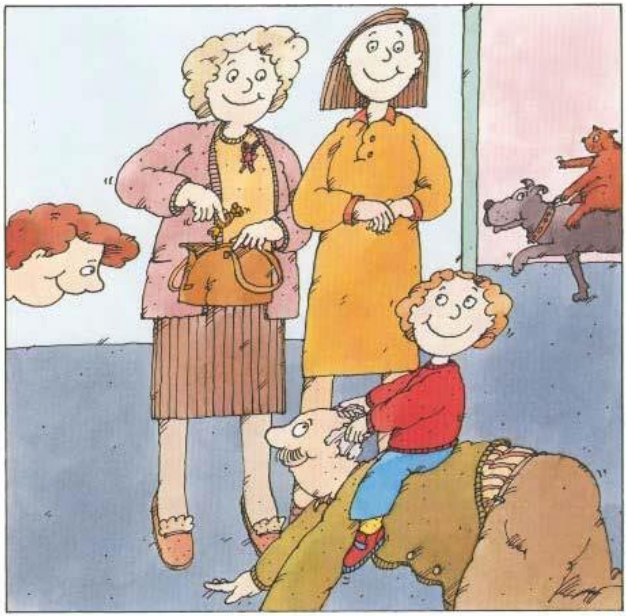
...along came Eric

GUS CLARKE

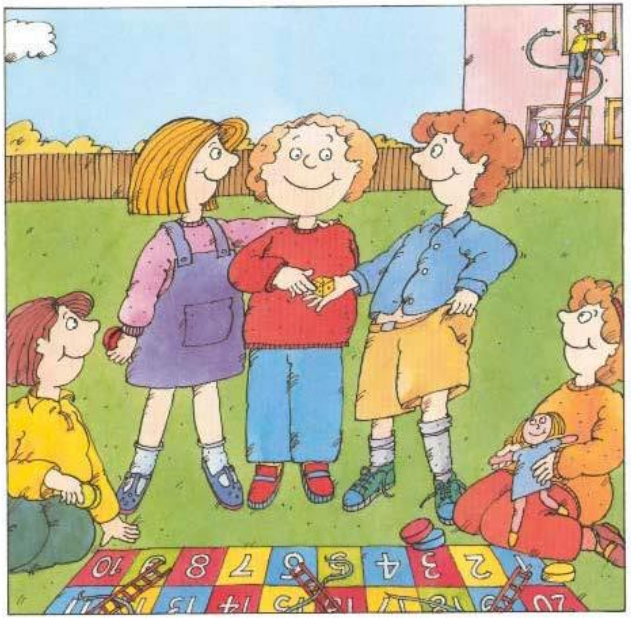


一个叫Nigel的幸福小男孩，他觉得家人和朋友都很爱他，后来Nigel有了弟弟Eric，发现所有人把爱都转移到Eric身上了，于是他变得有点失落。慢慢的Nigel和Eric都长大了，变得相亲相爱。最后他们迎来了小妹妹Alice……

Everybody liked Nigel.



Nigel's family all liked Nigel

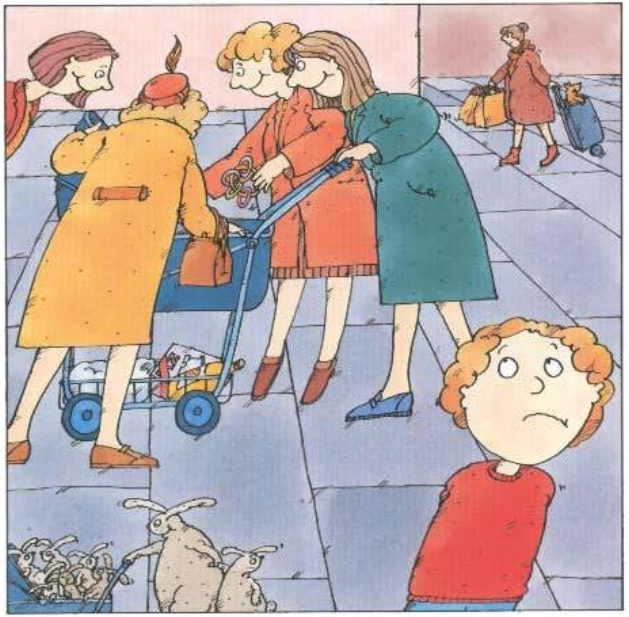


and, of course, all of Nigel's friends liked Nigel.

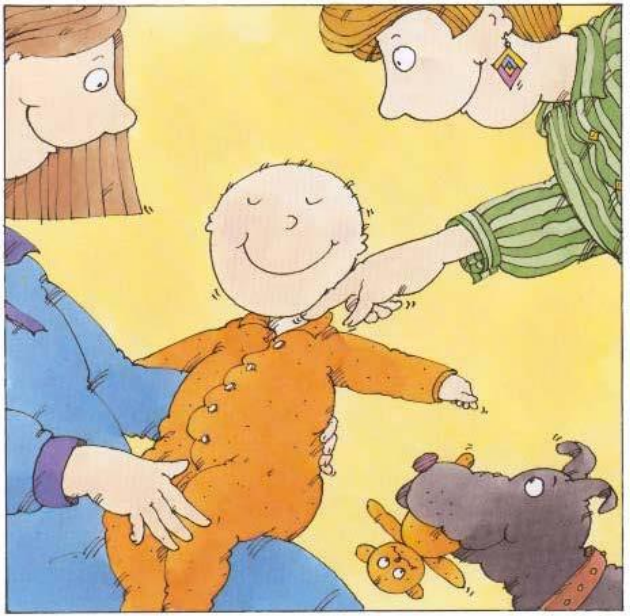
Father Christmas liked Nigel very much.

And, most of all, *Nigel* liked Nigel. (At least Nigel liked *being* Nigel, and that's just about the same thing.)

Then, along came Eric.

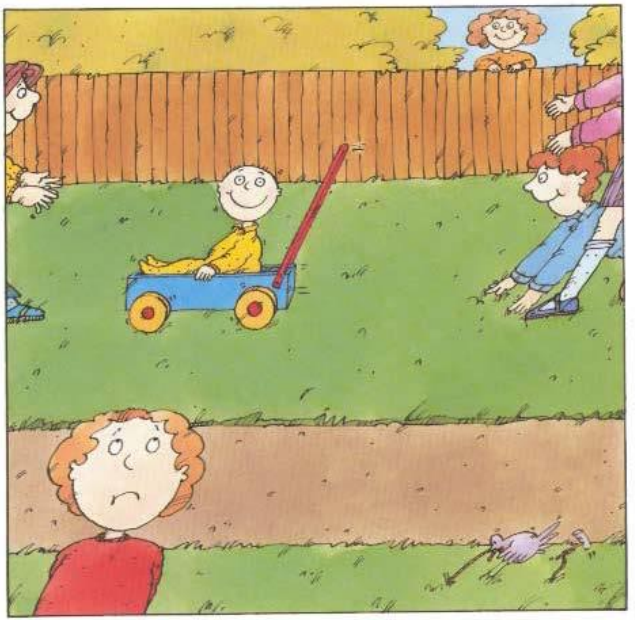


And it seemed to Nigel that suddenly nobody liked *Nigel* much anymore.

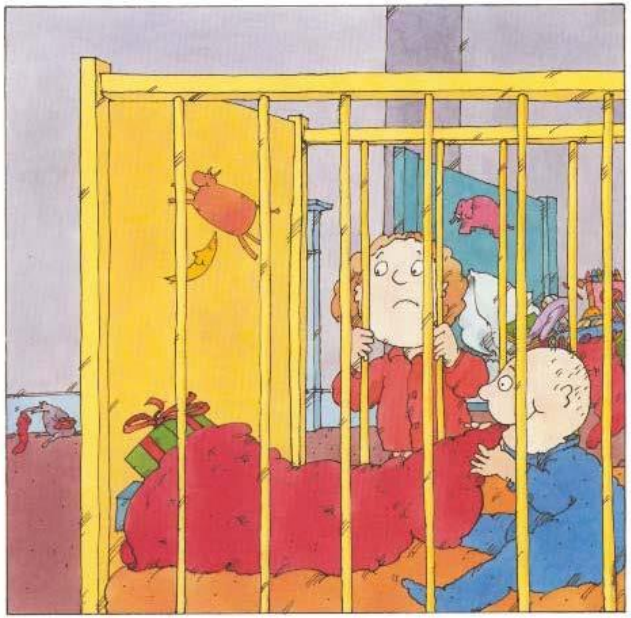


But everybody liked Eric a lot.

Nigel's family all liked Eric,

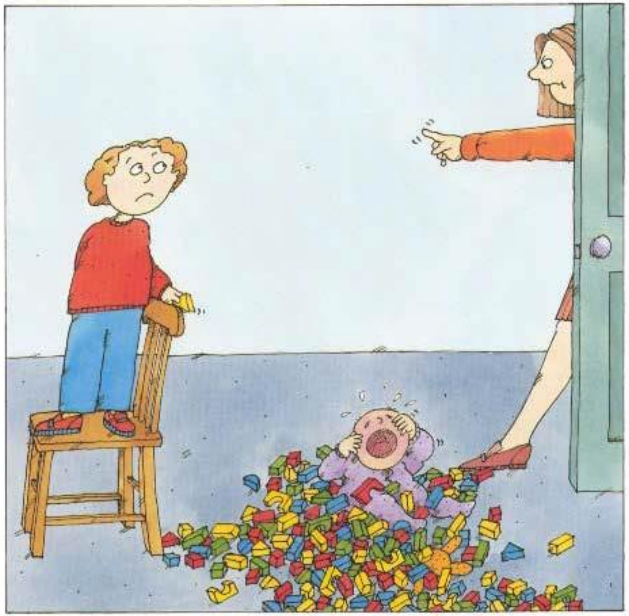


and all of Nigel's friends liked Eric.

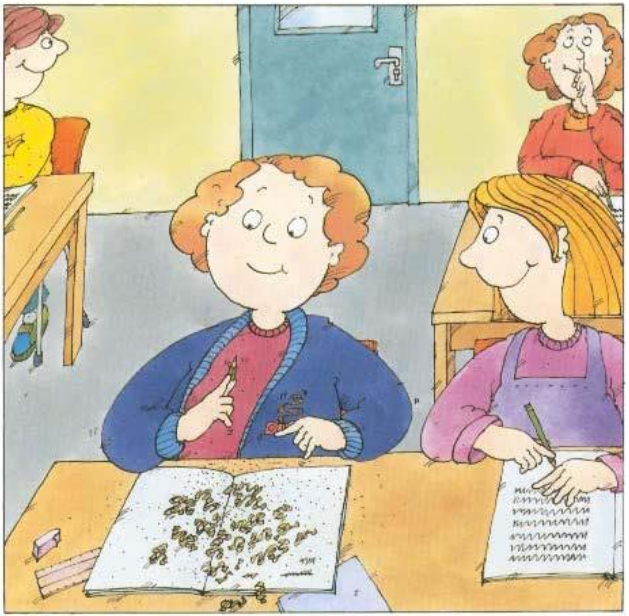


Father Christmas seemed to like Eric very much indeed.

But sometimes Nigel wasn't sure that *Nigel* liked Eric...



...at all.

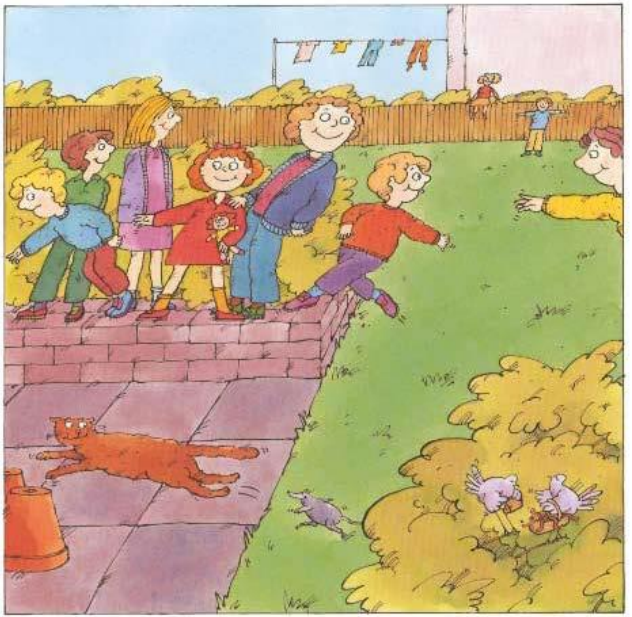


Years passed. Nigel grew up.

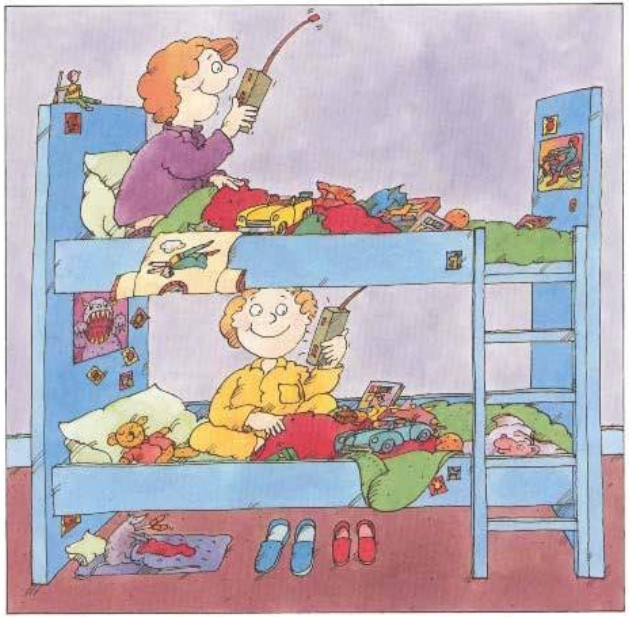
And so did Eric.

Nigel was surprised to find that nowadays everybody liked Eric *and* Nigel.

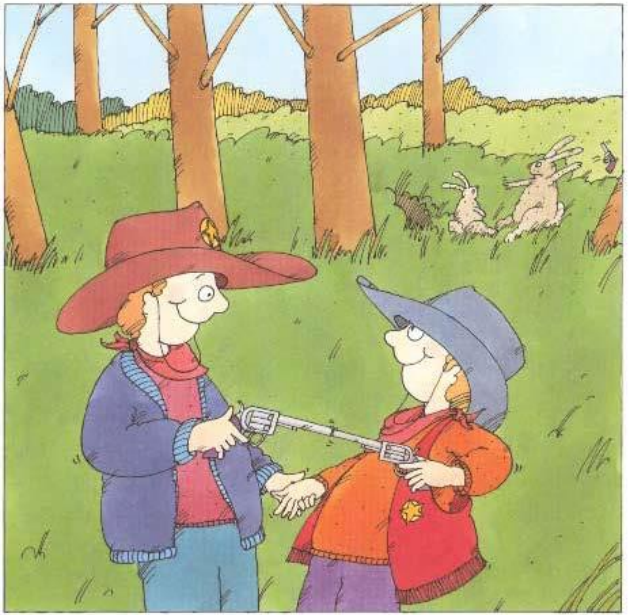
Nigel's family all liked Eric and Nigel (most of the time).



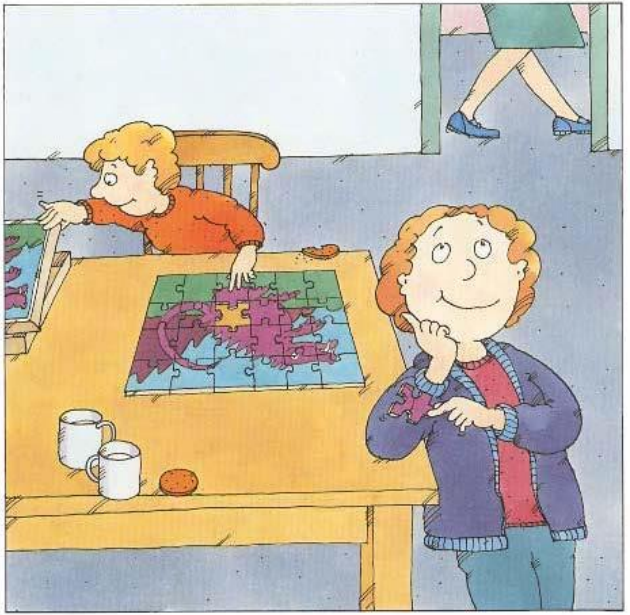
Nigel's friends still liked Eric, but Nigel didn't mind.
Eric had friends of his own now and they all seemed to like Nigel as well.



Father Christmas? Well, he's a busy man, but he still found time to visit them...both.



And, best of all, Nigel liked Eric and Eric liked Nigel. Very much.



"Life's not so bad," thought Nigel. (Eric had never thought it was.) But then...

...along came Alice.

Everybody liked Nigel.
所有人都喜欢奈杰尔。
Nigel's family all liked Nigel.
奈杰尔的家人都喜欢他。
And, of course, all of Nigel's friends liked Nigel.
当然了，奈杰尔所有的朋友也都喜欢他。
Father Christmas liked Nigel very much.
圣诞老人非常喜欢奈杰尔。
And, most of all, Nigel liked Nigel.
最重要的是，奈杰尔也喜欢他自己。
(At least Nigel liked being Nigel, and that's just about the same thing.)
（至少他很想成为自己，这两者差不多。）
Then, along came Eric.
接着，艾瑞克出生了。
And it seemed to Nigel that suddenly nobody liked Nigel much anymore.
对奈杰尔来说，似乎突然之间所有人都没那么爱他了。
But everybody liked Eric a lot.
但是每个人都非常喜欢艾瑞克。
Nigel's family all liked Eric,
奈杰尔的家人都喜欢艾瑞克。
and all of Nigel's friends liked Eric.
奈杰尔所有的朋友也都喜欢艾瑞克。
Father Christmas seemed to like Eric very much indeed.
圣诞老人似乎非常喜欢艾瑞克。
But sometimes Nigel wasn't sure that Nigel liked Eric...
但是有的时候，奈杰尔不确定自己是不是喜欢艾瑞克……
...at all.
其实一点都不喜欢。

Years passed. Nigel grew up.
很多年过去了，奈杰尔长大了。
And so did Eric.
艾瑞克也长大了。
Nigel was surprised to find that nowadays everybody liked Eric and Nigel.
奈杰尔惊奇地发现每个人都很喜欢他和艾瑞克。
Nigel's family all liked Eric and Nigel (most of the time).
奈杰尔的家人也都喜欢他们两个（大多数的时候是这样的）。
Nigel's friends still liked Eric, but Nigel didn't mind.
奈杰尔的朋友们依然喜欢艾瑞克，但奈杰尔并不介意了。
Eric had friends of his own now and they all seemed to like Nigel as well.
艾瑞克也有了自己的朋友，而且艾瑞克的朋友们也很喜欢奈杰尔。
Father Christmas? Well, he's a busy man,
至于圣诞老人？他太忙了，
but he still found time to visit them...both.
但他依然会抽时间来看他们两个。
And, best of all, Nigel liked Eric and Eric liked Nigel.
最重要的是，奈杰尔和艾瑞克都喜欢彼此。
Very much.
而且是非常喜欢。
" Life's not so bad, " thought Nigel.
“生活并没有很糟，”奈杰尔想。
(Eric had never thought it was.)
（艾瑞克从未想过这个问题。）
But then...
然而...
...along came Alice.
爱丽丝又出生了。